WOLF

FULL PRICE

PUBLISHER	PRICE	MACHINE	CONTROLS
Dalex Software	£7.95	SPECTRUM 128K	Keys

Dex is forty-nine, a touch soft round the middle, and he has joined the gym. Over January, February and March he works round six stations in a busy studio, pumping O and P to lift the bar, hitting SPACE on the lamps for clean reps and asking the coach for more weight. Stevo, Tim and Benny each run a session their own way, while the Pack (Pras, Kev, Gaz, Old Ron, Selfie Sid and Mo) go about their own business, very much in the spirit of Skool Daze, with lifting that tips its cap to Daley Thompson's Decathlon. Slack off and you collect red dots. Collect three and it's the punishment corner at the end of the session: 500 metres on the bike or the ski machine in a minute and a half, or try sneaking out of the door.



▲ *Three dots, and Stevo's bike awaits. Sneaking off is an option, sort of*

REVIEWED BY

Mick Dunsby, Prue Fairley, Norm Crabtree



▲ *Tim picks the ski machine, with a word about pyramids thrown in*

MICK DUNSBY

"Three dots and up comes the card: FINISHER TIME. Stevo puts me on the bike, Tim on the ski machine, and I pump O and P like a lunatic until the counter hits 500 metres with four seconds to spare. Dots wiped, and Stevo says he's proud of me. Lovely! Dex moves the instant you touch the keys, and the Pack are still a hoot: Gaz grunts UNGH! and drops his bar, Sid films himself at the mirror and Kev yells Coach! The catch? Folk stand right on top of Dex, a head pokes through the speech bubbles, the fifth rep box stays empty after a perfect set, and Sid shouts the instant you wander into his picture. Still, I kept going back for just one more month."

MD

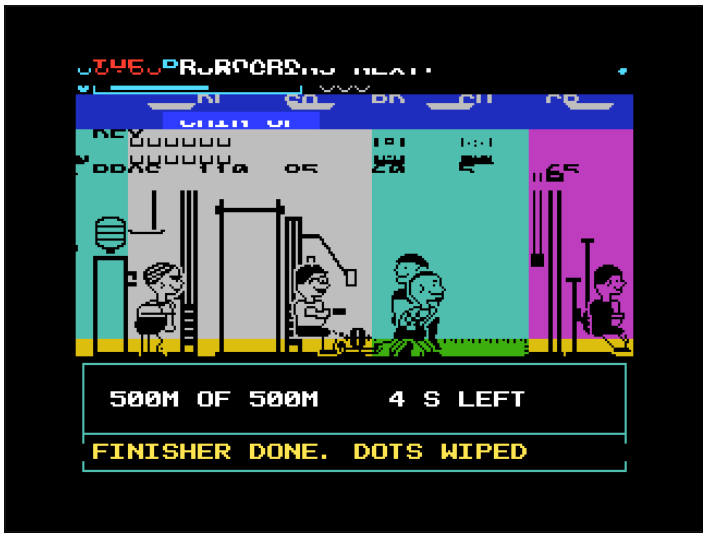
MICK SAYS **70%**

PRUE FAIRLEY

"Mick's ride is good fun, but fair it isn't, not always. Tim dots you the second you step off a station during a rest, and sometimes the slacking warning arrives with no nudge first. Tim keeps dishing out red dots when you've already got three, and however many you rack up the counter only ever shows three. Benny never hands out a dot, so his punishment ride never comes round. Pras and Ron collar you even when you're late, Pras's chat can pass without a word from him, and the reminder to pump away vanishes. Start a set, leave the keys alone and it never ends, buzzer or no buzzer. Benny's refusal asks for two clean sets when one will do, and I never once saw Tim blame anyone for Gaz's dropped bar."

PF

PRUE SAYS **60%**



▲ *Four seconds to spare and the dots are wiped, but the PB board scribbles itself over the studio*



▲ *Weight up to 45 kilos at the pull-down. Dex looks thrilled*

NORM CRABTREE

"Nearly four and a half minutes to load, so put the kettle on. On the 128 there's an anthem on the title, a pop tune for Stevo, a rap beat for Tim, disco for Benny and jingles for a PB and the end of a session; M turns the music off. The presentation creaks, mind. Miss the ride or sneak off and you're strapped up, but you're half a minute into the session before it says so. On the bike the clock sits at nought, Dex sneaking for the door is a dark crouched blob, and nobody in the room so much as cheers when you finish. Worse, the tape goes back to the title after three months, so a strap earned in March is forgotten. Fair fun, but not a lot of it for £7.95."

NC

NORM SAYS **64%**

THE LOWDOWN

CONTROL KEYS	O and P walk and pump, SPACE for the lamps and everything else, A for more weight, B to sneak off the punishment ride, H pauses (but it won't pause during the warm-up), M for music
USE OF COLOUR	Bright studio walls with black and white people on them, so clash is rare
GRAPHICS	Big readable heads, but on the title Stevo's white shirt merges with Dex's raised arm, Tim's bubble at the door points at the bloke beside him, and Kev's Coach! bubble crawls along and stays put while he walks off
SOUND	A title anthem, a tune for each coach and jingles on the 128, plus grunts and buzzers
SKILL LEVELS	One, though Stevo, Tim and Benny each keep their own rulebook
SCREENS	One studio two screens wide, the rota card, the finisher card and the PB board, whose bottom rows are a crowded jumble of lines
GENERAL RATING	A friendly lifting game whose punishment ride works, but the message line flickers for a blink, Stevo tells you off before he's even walked on, and Kev sometimes just points for a few seconds and wanders off

VERDICT

A cheery workout with a proper punishment at last, but too many rough edges and only three months of it. Worth a spot, not yet a personal best.

THE RATINGS

PRESENTATION	64%
GRAPHICS	61%
SOUND	71%
PLAYABILITY	64%
ADDICTIVE QUALITIES	62%

OVERALL

THE MIDDLE OF THREE MARKS

